MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering Candidate

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes-based test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral environments used by three product teams. Experienced in improving pipeline performance, building internal tooling and documenting technical workflows. Personal infrastructure projects include a GitOps-managed k3s cluster and Terraform provisioning for a small Hetzner VPS.

CORE SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal infrastructure project), Argo CD

Containers & Platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments to a shared cluster), k3s, Linux

Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Scripting & Testing: Python, Bash, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Java (test code), Postman, SQL

Cloud learning: AWS (EC2 and S3 basics)

Additional: Git, Ansible (basic), GitLab API

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments with Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built Python tooling to collect CI test results in PostgreSQL and Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Authored the internal CI workflow guide, now used in onboarding, and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications through manual and automated testing for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented per-merge-request environments deployed from GitLab CI using Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against isolated

environments; environments were automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results through the GitLab API into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team; flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1%.
- Technologies: Python, PostgreSQL, Grafana, GitLab API.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)